



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Woodstream Christian Academy
School Website: <https://woodstreamacademy.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Woodstream Christian Academy (WCA) presents a strongly classical Christian orientation across most core elements of classical education. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, biblical worldview, the Trivium-based framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with great books and classical inquiry, and a grammar-logic-rhetoric progression that spans K–12. The school foregrounds virtue, formation, and character alongside academic rigor, and it frames education as formation of persons in truth, goodness, and beauty. There is substantial evidence of a partnership ethos with parents and a structured, mentor-based faculty model. The main caveat is a documented instance of project-based lessons within the grammar-era pedagogy, which stands in tension with strict classical pedagogy that emphasizes memorization, recitation, and memory-work. Overall, the school is best described as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**, with clear classical impulses and strong religious/metaphysical grounding, but with pedagogical elements that diverge from a purely strict classical model in at least one grade-band.

Key observations from the two vector stores: - Public materials from WCA repeatedly affirm a classical Christian frame (biblical worldview, Christ-centered, grammar-logic-rhetoric emphasis, great books, and Latin in the grammar program) and articulate formation, virtue, and a mission oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty. The materials explicitly connect education to worshipful, communal, and church-aligned life, including liturgical practices and chapel. - The curriculum and pedagogy sections emphasize the Trivium, Great Books, and a structured progression through grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with explicit references to Latin study and the engagement with primary sources. There is also explicit attention to memory, recitation, songs, and contemplative elements in lower grades, consistent with Scholé pedagogy in places. However, there is a notable inclusion of project-based lessons in the grammar stage, which is a known negative indicator in classical pedagogy rubrics. - The faculty and administration are described in ways that align with the "living curriculum" and teacher-mentored culture, including department chairs and a structured educational-team model. This aligns with classical expectations for mentorship and a teacher-centered living curriculum. - Parent/community engagement is robust, with formal admissions standards, parent service hours, open houses, parent orientations, and ongoing opportunities for families to participate in school life, aligning with the classical model's emphasis on parent partnership.

Note on sources: The analysis draws on Woodstream Christian Academy's public materials that directly reference the school's Christ-centered, classical framework, including mission statements, philosophy of education, School of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric structure, and parent/family engagement practices. It also integrates the knowledge-based rubric for classically oriented schools (the Six Essential Elements) to identify positive and negative keyword indicators and to derive category-level scores. Key excerpts and indicators are cited inline with the sources listed above.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site presents a Bible-centered educational philosophy with phrases like “Rooted in Truth, Grounded in Christ,” “Classical Education, Biblical Foundation,” and “Christ-centered, biblical worldview.” The school describes education as founded on Scripture with a goal of forming students in truth, goodness, and beauty. - The school explicitly frames itself as a ministry of the Woodstream Church and emphasizes biblical doctrine as central to its philosophy of education; statements reference the Bible as the foundation of education and a center for all subjects. Chapel and liturgy-like references appear in public materials (e.g., Chapel in the program menu). - The motto Soli Deo Gloria and a church-linked governance/ethos are present in public documents, reinforcing transcendent aims and a theologically grounded formation framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; biblical worldview; Christ-centered; liturgy/chapel; sacred/holy; Logos; imago Dei (concepts implied within biblical formation); virtue (via character formation language). - Negative keywords: None clearly evident in the public materials; no overt relativism or secular ethics signals detected.

Why this rating - The materials consistently foreground transcendental goods (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in a biblical/metaphysical worldview and liturgical/community life, which aligns with the Classical rubric’s expectations for a religious/metaphysical foundation. The absence of negative signals in the public materials further supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials repeatedly articulate formation over mere information: “formation of virtue and wisdom,” “nurture students academically, spiritually, and morally,” and “Straight, Strong, Sharp” as a framework for human formation. The mission statement emphasizes forming character and virtue through a classical framework rooted in truth, goodness, and beauty. - There is explicit language about forming students for a life of virtue and leadership aligned with Christian values, not solely job preparation. The mission and philosophy emphasize formation (paideia-like aims) rather than a narrow workforce emphasis.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, character, moral realism, teleology, true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, virtue ethics, education for leisure/ contemplation, great conversation. - Negative keywords observed: none evident (no emphasis on job-prep-centric phrases or “21st century skills” in the public materials).

Why this rating - The materials frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, with a teleological aim toward the true/good/beautiful, consistent with classical thinking about the purpose of education. CLASSICAL aligns with the public materials.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly built around the liberal arts framework, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), and a Great Books/Latin emphasis. Public materials describe the School of Grammar and the School of Logic and Rhetoric, use of Great Books/ancient philosophy, and Latin study (e.g., “reading the great works of literature and ancient philosophy” and Latin study in grades 3–8). - There is explicit mention of a history-rich curriculum and an integrated approach to history across disciplines, plus a clear emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core tools of learning. The site also describes an integrated view of subjects with Scripture at the center. - Positive statements about the curriculum include a rigorous classical program grounded in a biblical worldview and a curriculum designed to foster critical thinking and intellectual curiosity.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: Seven Liberal Arts; grammar, logic, rhetoric; great books; Latin; history; wonder; integrated curriculum; classical education; primary sources; the Great Conversation. - Negative keywords observed: project-based lessons (present in Grammar School description), which is a known negative indicator in strict classical pedagogy rubrics.

Why this rating - The curricular architecture (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books/Latin; history across curriculum) aligns strongly with classical education norms. The presence of project-based lessons in the Grammar stage is a divergence, but the weight of the strictly classical curriculum elements dominates public materials, sustaining CLASSICAL overall.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower grades emphasize contemplative/restful elements and memory-based pedagogy (singing, chanting, and memory work), which align with Scholé pedagogy components. The presence of rest and contemplative elements in lower school is noted in the public materials. - Upper grades feature Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates, and rhetoric training, with opportunities for students to give speeches and develop rhetorical skills. This demonstrates explicit Socratic and argumentative pedagogy in the higher grade levels. - The grammar-stage description includes project-based lessons in some places, which is a known negative signal in classical pedagogy rubrics. That element appears in the grammar-stage description and “World of Exploration,” which includes research and thesis-style activities. - The school describes a “School of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric” structure and a progressive emphasis on memory, chant, recitation, and oratorical practice in the grammar stage, with more advanced rhetoric in the upper grades. This mix reflects elements of classical pedagogy, but the inclusion of project-based activities and some modern modalities create a partial deviation from a purist classical pedagogy.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: contemplative learning; scholé; memory work; singing/chanting for memorization; Socratic discussion; seminars; rhetoric; oratory/declamation; upper-level rhetoric theses; debate. - Negative keywords observed: project-based lessons (within grammar stage) indicating a potential deviation from strict classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - The pedagogy displays strong classical corners (Socratic discussions, memory-based lower-division pedagogy, rhetoric training in upper grades) but is tempered by the clear presence of project-based activities in the grammar stage. This mixed picture yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. If the school could align the grammar-stage pedagogy to more traditional memory-based recitation and reduce project-based emphasis there, the rating could shift toward CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents a structured organizational model with Head of School, Directors (Enrollment, Early Childhood, etc.), Department Chairs, Tutors, and a “living curriculum” vibe through its described roles and governance. The framework suggests teachers as mentors who model virtue and knowledge within a collaborative environment. - The presence of Department Chairs, specialized instructional leadership, and a focus on teacher development and accountability suggests a strong faculty culture consistent with classical expectations of skilled, virtuous teachers who serve as living exemplars. - The statements about the educational team, teacher training, and the alignment between mission and daily instruction indicate a faculty that “models virtue, skill, and knowledge” and that is part of the curriculum itself.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty as the core; portrait of teacher; teacher training; collegiality. - Negative keywords observed: none clearly evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The publicly documented faculty structure and emphasis on teacher leadership, mentorship, and a collaborative, mission-aligned faculty culture align with CLASSICAL outcomes in this domain. The absence of negative signals supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, defines parents as co-teachers, and invites parent involvement through various channels, including open houses, parent orientation, and book studies/gatherings. This aligns with the classical educational ideal of forming a broad educational community that includes parents as co-educators. - Public materials show explicit wording about parent formation (via the

website and gatherings) and an orientation toward open accessibility and ongoing parental engagement; the school notes that parents are welcome to visit and participate. - The school's governance and culture reflect a community-centered model with involvement from church/educational leaders, which reinforces a classical community orientation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords observed: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parent formation; book studies; gatherings; open campus; family liturgy alignment; parent involvement; parent visits. - Negative keywords observed: none evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates strong alignment with the classical ideal of engaged parents and a teaching community, with clear opportunities for parental involvement and formation. CLASSICAL is warranted here.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy alignment (Element 4): Reduce or remove project-based lessons in the grammar stage in favor of a more memory/recitation and analytic-narrative approach aligned with classical pedagogy, and clearly articulate a Scholé-focused schedule that emphasizes contemplative learning, memory work, and classical recitation in lower grades. This shift would push Element 4 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
- Explicit Great Books culture across levels (Element 3): Expand explicit references to Great Books and primary sources across more grade bands, and increase opportunities for direct engagement with classical texts in a way that parallels the Great Conversation ethos.
- Faculty development milestones (Element 5): Continue strengthening the living-curriculum emphasis with formal documentation of teacher-mentorship expectations and a formal portrait of teacher-figures to reinforce the "model teachers and mentors" criterion.
- Parental formation programming (Element 6): Expand formal parent-education offerings (e.g., classical book clubs, theology/philosophy seminars) to further institutionalize parents as co-teachers and deepen community formation.

Note: The needle-mover list targets concrete, verifiable adjustments that would move the Pedagogy category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL, while preserving the school's strong classical-Christian orientation in the other domains.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

By reading or using this document, you acknowledge and accept the limitations described above.